

Introduction into Cognitive Linguistics (FA24)

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Introduction into Cognitive Linguistics

Term: Fall 2024

Time: 12 period

Instructor: Valentina Apresyan

Room: Fairchild 008

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Course Overview

This course offers an introduction to cognitive linguistics, a field that explores the relationship between language and human cognition. Cognitive linguistics emphasizes how our bodies and brains shape our understanding and use of language, as well as how language influences our perceptions and opinions. The course examines how our physical and mental experiences impact language structure and usage, and how the grammar and vocabulary of our native language shape our perceptions of space, color, emotions, and more.

For example, attentional biases influence our word choices in spatial and temporal constructions, while physical experiences shape how we express mental and emotional concepts. At the same time, specific metaphors can sway our opinions, and cross-linguistic differences in spatial vocabulary can alter our perception of space.

We will explore key cognitive linguistic concepts such as metaphor, categorization, frame semantics, goal bias, and prototype theory. We will discuss how these concepts can be applied to the analysis of real-world phenomena, including online media, humor, language learning, and even gesticulation.

By the end of the course, you will have...

- Gained familiarity with fundamental concepts and skills in cognitive linguistics and acquired the ability to apply them to specific contexts.
- Developed basic proficiency in utilizing various research methods, including corpus analysis, interviewing, and behavioral experiment.
- Obtained practical experience in applying cognitive linguistic analysis to diverse real-life contexts and tasks.

Teaching methods:

The course format incorporates lectures, reading discussions, practical exercises, creative assignments, and a research project. Students will employ diverse research methods, including behavioral experiments, linguistic corpora analysis, and interviews.

Expectations and norms

Students are expected to attend classes and actively engage in classwork, as well as submit their assignments punctually. The deadline for work submission is before the beginning of the class when a particular assignment is due. Extra credit is not available.

Students are responsible for monitoring their progress in the course and are encouraged to schedule office hour appointments with me to discuss class material and progress.

In the case of inability to attend due to serious reasons, students must inform me in advance to avoid missing classwork.

If students encounter difficulties keeping up with the course or have concerns about any aspect of the class, they are strongly encouraged to discuss the matter with me to prevent major issues from arising. I will be happy to listen, to discuss, to help, and to work together on the best solutions for any class-related matter.

Commitment to an inclusive classroom:

It is important that we create a learning environment that recognizes and celebrates the diversity of thoughts, ideas, backgrounds, and experiences of all students. Healthy debate and discussion is encouraged, including to point out implicit or explicit bias in any of the readings, but bullying and gaslighting will not be tolerated. At all times remember to practice empathy and recognize that we all (myself included) have much to learn from one another.

If you have any concerns about your performance in the class due to circumstances and experiences outside of class, please contact me. If anything was said in class that made you uncomfortable or you have concerns about the classroom atmosphere, please contact me. I will also have a means of providing anonymous feedback, from which I will make general announcements in class as necessary to address the concerns.

Academic honor principle

The faculty, administration, and students of Dartmouth College acknowledge the responsibility to maintain and perpetuate the principle of academic honor, and recognize that any instance of academic dishonesty is considered a violation of the [Academic Honor Principle](https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/policy/academic-honor-principle) [↗ \(https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/policy/academic-honor-principle\)](https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/policy/academic-honor-principle).

Plagiarism is unacceptable. For all written coursework, sources should be cited appropriately, including any online sources. For more information: www.dartmouth.edu/~writing/sources/ [↗ \(http://www.dartmouth.edu/~writing/sources/\)](http://www.dartmouth.edu/~writing/sources/)

For more information and guidance on standards of conduct, see <https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/> [↗ \(https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/\)](https://students.dartmouth.edu/community-standards/)

Student accessibility and accommodations

Students requesting disability-related accommodations and services for this course are required to register with Student Accessibility Services (SAS; [Apply for Services webpage](https://students.dartmouth.edu/student-accessibility/students/where-start/apply-services) [↗ \(https://students.dartmouth.edu/student-accessibility/students/where-start/apply-services\)](https://students.dartmouth.edu/student-accessibility/students/where-start/apply-services); student.accessibility.services@dartmouth.edu [↗ \(mailto:student.accessibility.services@dartmouth.edu\)](mailto:student.accessibility.services@dartmouth.edu); 1-603-646-9900) and to request that an accommodation email be

sent to me in advance of the need for an accommodation. Then, students should schedule a follow-up meeting with me to determine relevant details such as what role SAS or its [Testing Center](https://students.dartmouth.edu/student-accessibility/services/testing-center)  (<https://students.dartmouth.edu/student-accessibility/services/testing-center>) may play in accommodation implementation. This process works best for everyone when completed as early in the quarter as possible. If students have questions about whether they are eligible for accommodations or have concerns about the implementation of their accommodations, they should contact the SAS office. All inquiries and discussions will remain confidential.

Religious observances

Dartmouth has a deep commitment to support students' religious observances and diverse faith practices. Some students may wish to take part in religious observances that occur during this academic term. If you have a religious observance that conflicts with your participation in the course, please meet with me as soon as possible—before the end of the second week of the term at the latest—to discuss appropriate course adjustments.

Generative Artificial Intelligence

The use of GAI platforms in this class is guided by the same principle as the legitimate use of human input and advice, ensuring that it does not jeopardize the originality of your own work. This means that you can use GAI for tasks such as brainstorming, identifying useful resources, grammar checking, and assistance with translation. However, you cannot use AI for generating your own work. If you use a generative AI, you must acknowledge its contribution by providing a clear citation. For example, if you use ChatGPT-3, you must cite ChatGPT-3, along with the date and text of your query. Failure to acknowledge the use of an AI tool for legitimate tasks or using AI to generate your own work, such as a paper or its parts, comments for the discussion forum, or a homework submission, is considered a violation of the Academic Honor Principle.

Approximate schedule (subject to change) --- READING LIST AND VIDEO MATERIALS ARE STILL BEING REVISED:

Week Date Topic	Reading/Listening Watching/Observing	Other
1 Sept 16 Course logistics. Intro.	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RKK7wGAYP6k  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RKK7wGAYP6k  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RKK7wGAYP6k (Lera Boroditsky on how language shapes thinking)	Experiment in class (TL, word c
1 Sept 18 Basic concepts (lecture) (construal,	Oxford Handbook https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012413 .p. 27-31, 48-53, 122-125	Practice in class: stories with di analysis of construal and protot

1	Sept 20	Discussion	Klibanoff & Waxman 2000 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012414) Lakoff & Johnson (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012469), p. 3-24 Oxford Handbook (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012413) p. 188-198 Video (It's morning again in America)  (https://dartmouth.hosted.panopto.com/Panopto/Pages/Viewer.aspx?id=3bfd172a-5461-4027-9e07-b1e000df8dbb)	Discussion 1 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/discussions/13012414)
2	Sept 23	Metaphor (lecture)	Scherer et al. 2015 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012423)	Discussion 2 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/discussions/13012423)
2	Sept 25	Reading discussion: How do media metaphors frame our perception?	Homework 1 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484823) : collect, gloss and translate conceptual metaphors from a language other than English (introspection, interview, dictionaries)	in class: analyze metaphor collection
2	Sept 27	Practice: metaphors cross-linguistically	Oxford Handbook (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012413) p. 198-201, 377-392	
3	Sept 30	Conceptual blending (lecture)	Video with conceptual blending (Apple ad)  (https://dartmouth.hosted.panopto.com/Panopto/Pages/Viewer.aspx?id=cc6df0c3-eabf-42b9-8ca5-b1e000df9314)	

3	Oct 2	Reading discussion: conceptual blending in archeology	Yamasaki 2024 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012427)	Discussion 3 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012427)
3	Oct 4	Practice: uses of conceptual blending	Homework 2 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484824)	in class: conceptual blending in examples Collect and analyze an example of a linguistic, visual or other object that incorporates conceptual blending
4	Oct 7	Figure and ground, profile and base (lecture)	Talmy 1975 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012419)	in-class experiment
4	Oct 9	Reading discussion: Figure and ground in language of the music	Wadley et al. 2024 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012420)	Discussion 4 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012420)
4	Oct 11	Practice: figure and ground in fiction	Homework 3 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484825)	In class: figure and ground in ci Describe an example of figure-ground opposition in language, painting, music, film
5	Oct 14	Spatial orientation: reference frames (lecture)	Oxford Handbook (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012413), p. 327-334	Experiment with frames of refer Final project proposal due  (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1hSf1IPSSgO_dmZ58Zoot0/edit)
5	Oct 16	Reading discussion: Can language restructure cognition? orientation, gestures	Majid et al. 2004 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012470)	Discussion 5 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012470)

5	Oct 18	Practice	Homework 4 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484826)	Analyze collected language sa
6	Oct 21	Goal bias: cognitive and linguistic aspects	Ikegami 1979 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012421)	video experiment in class
6	Oct 23	Reading discussion Source-goal asymmetry in memory and language	Chen et al. 2024 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012425)	Discussion 6 (https://dartmouth.instructure.cc)
6	Oct 25	Practice	Homework 5 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484827)	Video clips, corpus analysis of Create your own video clip for goal-source experiment
7	Oct 28	Frames and constructions	Oxford Handbook (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012413), p. 464-472, 760-763	FrameNet
7	Oct 30	Cognitive linguistic analysis of humor	Cognitive linguistics and humor (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012415), ch. 9 (167-178) - if you wish, you can finish the whole chapter till p. 190, but that is not required	Discussion 7 (https://dartmouth.instructure.cc)
7	Nov 1	Practice	Homework 6 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484828) Bring three jokes to class (and describe their mechanism for HW) for an experiment (you can bring a joke with role reversal, pun or any other joke type with some frame- shifting that you saw in the paper) - the first two, real jokes (one "professional" or folklore and one contextual from real life) and the third an AI-generated joke (with the use of the prompt you formulate), e.g. produce a pun-based joke about ducks; produce a role-reversal joke about X and Y (e.g., two countries of your choice, or doctor and patient, or another scenario)	In class, we will have an exper tackle 1) comparison of human for processing of difficult, easy, real experiment, but we can get
8	Nov 4	Color terms in languages of the world	Dowman 2006 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012416)	

8	Nov 6	Color terms in Mandarin Chinese	Sun & Chen 2018 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/files/13012417)	Discussion 8 (https://dartmouth.instructure.cc)
8	Nov 8	Practice	Homework 7 (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484829)	Experiment in class, discuss the results Report the results of your group experiment
9	Nov 11	Presentations of final projects		
9	Nov 13	Presentations of final projects		
9	Nov 15	Presentations of final projects		
10	Nov 18	Review for final exam		

Grading:

Class attendance and participation	20 %
Reading discussions (discussion board)	16%
Written homework	14%
Final exam	25 %
Final project	25%
(10 % for the oral presentation and 15 % for the written report)	

Class attendance and participation

Students are expected to attend classes and actively engage in class discussions, practices, and other activities.

Reading discussions

We will a research paper every week and comment on it using a discussion board.

Written homework

You will get analytical or creative home assignments which you will submit on Canvas prior to class.

Final exam

During the exam, you will have to demonstrate the knowledge of the most essential notions learnt throughout the course and ability to apply them to specific linguistic material.

Final group project

For your final group project, you are asked to apply the cognitive linguistic concepts acquired in the course in an analytical way to test a hypothesis using quantitative analysis to prove or disprove it. Here are some example project ideas:

- Media Metaphors and Perception:
 - Hypothesis: Different metaphors used in media texts frame our perception of an event in distinct ways.
 - Method: Compare distributions of participant responses to two texts that are identical except for the metaphors used.
- Processing of Idioms:
 - Hypothesis: Different types of idioms are processed at varying speeds and accuracy levels, depending on the degree of their semantic transparency.
 - Method: Analyze differences in reaction times and rates of correct interpretations of various idioms.
- Memorization of Figurative vs. Literal Language:
 - Hypothesis: Sentences with idiomatic components are recalled differently than literal sentences.
 - Method: Compare recall rates of sentences with and without idiomatic expressions.
- Color terms in different languages:

Hypothesis: The same color category is associated with different color terms depending on the type of colored object.

Method: Compare usage of color terms across a number of speakers of the same language in reference to different types of objects that share the same color category (e.g., green leaves, green sea, green eyes, green dresses).

- Cross-linguistic comprehension of idioms:

Hypothesis: idioms based on conceptual metaphors have a higher degree of cross-linguistic interpretability than idioms that have a cultural or historical basis.

Method: collect a sample of idioms of two kinds from a language other than English, translate them into English and compare their relative comprehension in a number of English speakers unfamiliar with the source language.

- Linguistic representation of motion events affects gesticulation:

Hypothesis: Speakers of verb-framed languages, such as Spanish or French, which express the path in the verb and the manner in the complement (*Entró corriendo* '(S)he entered running') and speakers of satellite-framed languages, such as English, which express the manner in the verb and the path in the preposition (*He ran in*), represent motion events in gesticulation in a different way: speakers of verb-framed languages encode the path, while speakers of satellite-framed languages encode the manner.

Method: interview a group of speakers from each language and compare their gesticulation.

Texts and materials

Textbook:

There is no single textbook. All readings will be made available on Canvas. The primary handbook used will be the "Oxford Handbook of Cognitive Linguistics," edited by Geeraerts, D., and H. Cuyckens, Oxford Handbooks (online edition 2012).

Handbooks (chapters and excerpts):

Oxford Handbook of Cognitive Linguistics, ed. by Geeraerts, D., and H. Cuyckens, Oxford Handbooks (online edition 2012).

Online language resources (corpora and databases)

sketchengine.co.uk

skell.sketchengine.co.uk

<https://www.english-corpora.org/coca/> ↗ [\(https://www.english-corpora.org/coca/\)](https://www.english-corpora.org/coca/)

<https://www.latl.leeds.ac.uk/resources/corpora-and-corpus-tools/> ↗ [\(https://www.latl.leeds.ac.uk/resources/corpora-and-corpus-tools/\)](https://www.latl.leeds.ac.uk/resources/corpora-and-corpus-tools/)

<https://framenet.icsi.berkeley.edu/> ↗ [\(https://framenet.icsi.berkeley.edu/\)](https://framenet.icsi.berkeley.edu/)

Glossing

<https://www.eva.mpg.de/lingua/pdf/Glossing-Rules.pdf> ↗ [\(https://www.eva.mpg.de/lingua/pdf/Glossing-Rules.pdf\)](https://www.eva.mpg.de/lingua/pdf/Glossing-Rules.pdf)

Course Summary:

Date	Details	Due
Sat Sep 21, 2024	 Discussion 1, Basic level objects (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484791)	due by 1am
Fri Sep 27, 2024	 HW1, Metaphor (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484823)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Oct 2, 2024	 Discussion 3, Conceptual blending (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484793)	due by 1:50pm
Fri Oct 4, 2024	 HW2, Blending (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484824)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Oct 9, 2024	 Discussion 4, Figure and Ground (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484817)	due by 1:50pm
Fri Oct 11, 2024	 HW3, Figure-Ground (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484825)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Oct 16, 2024	 Discussion 5, Frames of reference (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484818)	due by 1:50pm
Fri Oct 18, 2024	 HW4, Reference frames (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484826)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Oct 23, 2024	 Discussion 6, Source-Goal (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484819)	due by 1:50pm
Fri Oct 25, 2024	 HW5, Goal-Source (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484827)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Oct 30, 2024	 Discussion 7, Humor (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484821)	due by 1:50pm

Date	Details	Due
Fri Nov 1, 2024	 Homework 6, Jokes (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484828)	due by 12:50pm
Wed Nov 6, 2024	 Discussion 8, Color (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484822)	due by 1:50pm
Fri Nov 8, 2024	 HW7, Results of your group project (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484829)	due by 12:50pm
Tue Nov 26, 2024	 Final exam (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484786)	due by 2:30pm
Wed Nov 27, 2024	 Final project (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484787)	due by 11:59pm
	 Discussion 2 Metaphor framing (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/486583)	
	 Participation (https://dartmouth.instructure.com/courses/67213/assignments/484790)	